

nect all peripherals, such as monitors, keyboards, mice, and external storage devices, to prevent accidental damage during disassembly.

Step 3: Put on the anti-static strap

Static electricity can damage sensitive electronic components. To minimize the risk, put on an anti-static wrist strap and connect it to a grounded metal object, such as your computer's case or a grounded metal table leg.

Step 4: Remove the side panel

Most computer cases have either one or two removable side panels. To remove the panel, locate the screws or latches securing it to the case and carefully slide it off. Set the panel aside in a safe location.

Step 5: Inspect and take pictures

Before you begin disassembling the internal components, take a moment to inspect the inside of your computer. Look for any obvious signs of damage, such as burnt components or leaking capacitors. Taking photos of your PC's interior can be helpful for reference during reassembly, especially if you're unfamiliar with the layout.

Step 6: Disconnect all cables

Carefully disconnect all cables connecting the various components inside your PC. This may include power cables, data cables, and front panel connectors. Keep track of which cables connect to which components, as this will make reassembly much easier.

When disconnecting cables, be gentle and avoid pulling on the wires themselves. Instead, grasp the connectors and wiggle them gently until they come free.

Step 7: Remove expansion cards

Expansion cards, such as graphics cards, sound cards, or network adapters, are typically secured to the case with a single screw and inserted into a slot on the motherboard. To remove an expansion card:

1. Unscrew the card from the case.
2. Gently grasp the card by its edges or the heatsink, avoiding any sensitive components.
3. Press down on the latch (if present) at the base of the slot.
4. Gently pull the card straight out of the slot.
5. Store the expansion cards in an anti-static bag or another safe location to prevent damage.

Step 8: Remove the RAM modules

To remove the RAM modules:

1. Locate the RAM slots on the motherboard, usually positioned near the CPU.
2. Press down on the tabs located on either side of the

RAM module.

3. Gently lift the RAM module straight up and out of the slot.
4. Handle the RAM modules by their edges, and store them in an anti-static bag or a safe location.

Step 9: Remove the CPU Cooler

CPU coolers come in various designs, such as air coolers and liquid coolers. To remove an air cooler:

1. Locate the retention mechanism, which may be a clip, latch, or set of screws.
2. Carefully release the retention mechanism according to its design.
3. Gently lift the cooler off the CPU.
4. For a liquid cooler, follow the manufacturer's instructions for removing the cooler and disconnecting the tubing. Be cautious not to spill any liquid on the computer components.
5. Once the cooler is removed, clean any remaining thermal paste from the CPU and cooler using a lint-free cloth and isopropyl alcohol.

Step 10: Remove the CPU

1. Locate the CPU socket on the motherboard.
2. Release the retention arm or lever securing the CPU in place.
3. Gently lift the CPU straight up and out of the socket.
4. Handle the CPU by its edges and avoid touching the pins or contacts. Store the CPU in an anti-static bag or a safe location.

Step 11: Remove the Power Supply Unit

1. Unscrew the PSU from the case, usually secured by four screws at the back.
2. Carefully lift the PSU out of the case, being mindful of any cables still connected to the case (such as front panel connectors).
3. Store the PSU in a safe location, away from other components.

Step 12: Remove the storage

1. Locate the drive bays or mounting locations in your case.
2. Unscrew the drives from their mounting locations or release any latches or clips securing them in place.
3. Carefully slide the drives out of their bays or mounting locations.
4. Store the drives in an anti-static bag or another safe location.

Step 13: Remove the Motherboard

1. Disconnect any remaining cables connected to the motherboard, such as front panel connectors.
2. Unscrew the motherboard from the case, typically secured by 6 to 9 screws.